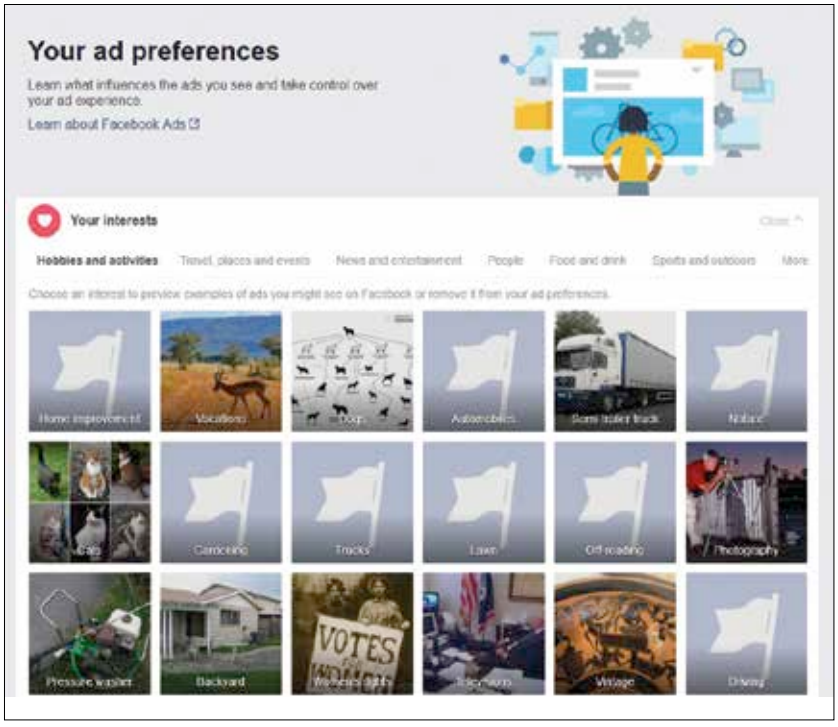
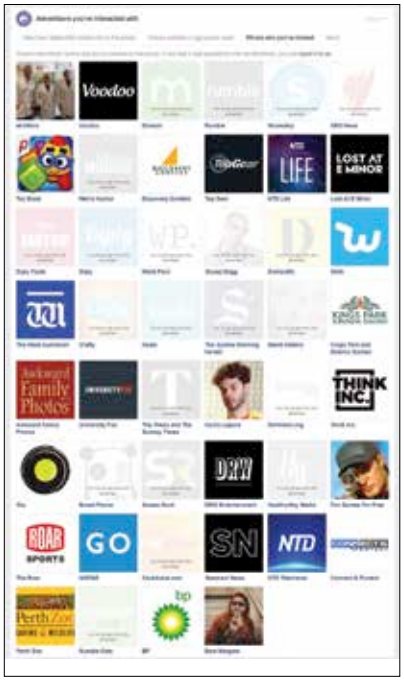



Don't judge me... everyone loves cats! Especially internet cats!

As someone who is directionally challenged, and often gets lost in malls, it's obvious I need all the help I can get when navigating every city I've lived in. Google Maps knows every single journey I've taken, and every route I took and places I stopped at for years. Not that this is some closely guarded secret, because Google is upfront about all of this, but since everyone seems so shocked about the Facebook leaks, I figure I should bring this up.




I have no clue when I clicked on ads from these companies, but apparently I did!

If all of that data wasn't enough, there's also YouTube, so that Google knows what I do for leisure, and what videos and topics I've seen since the beginning of time. Now, if you're like me, and just stay signed in to your Google account while you use Chrome to surf the net, you're pretty much handing Google more information than we share with our spouses! It's a safe bet to assume that Google knows you better than you know yourself.

And before you happily jump up and down claiming you knew this all along and that's why you use a different browser... sit back down, because pretty much every site on the internet uses Google ads, or some ad network that Google is tied up with to display ads, and every single site you visit is being tracked that way. Basically, if you're online, using the internet, someone is tracking you, and it's almost a surety that Google or Facebook or both are the ones doing the tracking, because we stay logged in to both services.

I'm sure I don't have to add in the more obvious services such as Google Search, Translate, Play, Google+, Drive, Photos, and more. Don't even get me started on Analytics, Ads and more which not only keep a track of you but also every single visitor to your website as well. Google Shopping, Flights, News, Duo, and more also play influencer, and if you use Android, then, well, Gboard knows absolutely everything you do on your phone. Everything!

I'm not suggesting it's like a keylogger, but just my personal dictionary's learned words, suggested phrases, and autocorrect info would tell you a lot more about me than if you read every article by me over the past 16 years!

If I really was worried about being influenced, I might fear Facebook more, but if you ask me who knows me better, I have to think Google knows far more about me than Facebook ever could. Is it the same or different for you?

### 3. Apple

Apple loves to call itself the privacy champion amongst the big companies. Because it doesn't rely heavily on ad networks like the two mentioned before, it's less likely to use your data in the same way. That's not to say that Apple doesn't have your data, and doesn't use big data tools, because they certainly do. Unlike Google and Facebook, however, Apple is pretty secretive about such internal functioning, and it's hard to get a page like you do for the other two where all your data is displayed. From the little




Be careful of what you include, because it can be a rather large file